# What's Missing From This CCNA Course

Questions to ask the institute — aligned to the 2026 CCNA 200-301 v1.1 blueprint

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**1. AI & Machine Learning in Networking**
Generative AI fundamentals, predictive AI, and ML-driven anomaly detection are now an explicit, testable domain. Not mentioned anywhere in this syllabus.

**2. Cloud Networking (beyond one line)**
Cloud-managed networking (Meraki-style), SD-WAN concepts, and hybrid on-prem/cloud models. Current syllabus has a single bullet defining cloud vs on-prem — not real training.

**3. Automation Tooling**
Ansible or any config-management tool. Course covers API/REST/JSON theory only, with no hands-on automation tool.

**4. First-Hop Redundancy Protocols (HSRP/VRRP)**
Falls under IP Connectivity — the single largest exam domain (25%). Missing entirely, even though OSPF is covered.

**5. Modern Wireless Security (WPA3)**
Syllabus only says "wireless security protocols" generically — WPA3 is not named specifically.

**6. Advanced STP & Layer 2 Hardening**
BPDU Guard, Loop Guard, UDLD. Course only covers basic Rapid PVST+ and PortFast.

**7. SD-Access / Fabric Concepts**
Overlay, underlay, and control/data-plane separation. DNA Center is mentioned as a one-line "overview" only — too shallow for what's testable.

**8. Zero Trust / Modern Security Architecture**
Not present at all. Increasingly expected context given how security-first design is now woven into the 2026 blueprint.

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## One Structural Question to Ask

This course teaches the general CCNA 200-301 track. For a SOC analyst career goal specifically, **CCNA CyberOps (200-201)** is the more direct path — it covers incident response and security monitoring that 200-301 doesn't touch. Ask the institute whether they offer CyberOps, and whether it should come before or instead of the general CCNA.

## Quick Checklist to Take to the Institute

- [ ] Do you cover Generative AI / ML topics in network operations?
- [ ] Is real cloud/SD-WAN networking taught, or just a definition?
- [ ] Will we get hands-on practice with Ansible or another automation tool?
- [ ] Is HSRP (first-hop redundancy) covered under routing?
- [ ] Is WPA3 taught explicitly as part of wireless security?
- [ ] Do labs include BPDU Guard, Loop Guard, and UDLD?
- [ ] Is SD-Access / DNA Center covered in depth, or just mentioned?

[ ] Do you offer CCNA CyberOps (200-201) — and is it a better fit for a SOC-analyst goal?

Note: The fundamentals in this course (OSI/TCP-IP, subnetting, VLANs, STP, routing) are solid and match what's still core to the exam. These gaps sit in the newer ~10-15% of content Cisco added in the 2024-2026 blueprint refresh — small in exam weight, but the part that signals real 2026 job-readiness to an employer.